

"Cell" phones

Base stations are spread out across a country. Each base station stands in its own area, which is called a cell. This is how cell phones got their name.



Second
base
station

Quick quiz



What does a phone send to a base station?



What did the first text message say?

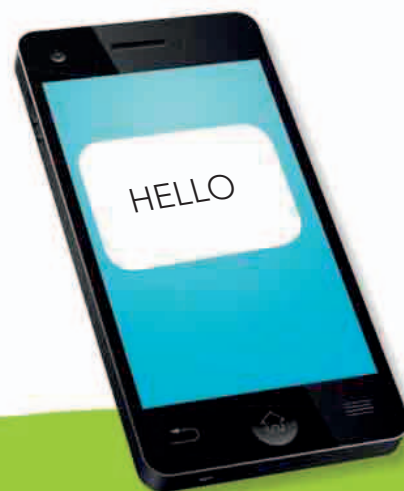
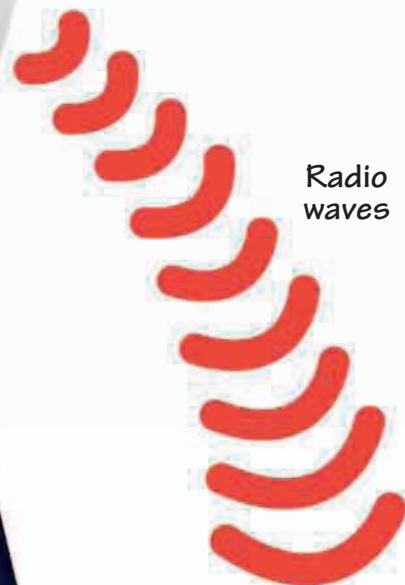


How many base stations are in a cell?

Switching
office



Radio
waves



3 Switch around

The computers in the switching office find the base station nearest to the phone that the text is being sent to. It then passes the signal along cables to this base station.

4 Second base

The second base station receives the signal, turns it back into radio waves, and sends them through the air to the phone.

5 Message received!

The phone picks up the radio waves and changes them back into the original message.